



*Baldr's death caused such grief
that the gods could do nothing but weep.*

Baldr's body was then held aloft and carried to his own ship. Odin leaned over and whispered into Baldr's ear, but no one knows what he said.

*The Aesir gods placed Baldr on the deck of his ship,
but the ship was so heavy they couldn't push it
from the beach to the sea.*

So the gods summoned a giantess called Hyrrokkin, who rode up on a giant wolf, using snakes for reins. She pushed the ship so forcefully, the log rollers caught fire and the ground shook.

As the ship began to drift away, Nanna – Baldr's wife – died from sorrow and she was placed alongside him.

Many watched Baldr burn: Odin, Frigg, the Valkyries; Freyr and his boar, Gold Bristle; Heimdall and his horse, Golden Forelock; Freya in her cat-drawn chariot; even giants and dwarfs.

Eventually, Frigg gathered herself. She asked if anyone was willing to travel to Niflheim and bargain with Hel, the goddess of the dead, for Baldr's return. Baldr's brother Hermod agreed and set off on Odin's horse, Sleipnir.

Hermod rode for nine days through pitch-black valleys until he reached Gjöll, the noisy river that separates the living from the dead.